how New Delhi's need to counter Beijing's courtship of Tehran raises important questions for India's relations with the United States.

Acknowledging that the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation is a profoundly China-led institution, **P. Stobdan** explores whether India, by joining the SCO, is gradually adapting to a China-led order in the region or if membership in SCO is rather an effort by New Delhi to check and counter China's growing footprint in India's neighbourhood. In Chapter 8, **Constantino Xavier** argues that India today faces two converse structural challenges. At the global level, it increasingly lags behind China in terms of hard economic and military capabilities; as a result, New Delhi is forced to develop alternative non-military strategies to counter Beijing. At the regional level, however, India has increased the power asymmetry with its smaller neighbours, requiring it to promote its expanding capabilities as a non-threatening "soft power." Offering a survey of these two structural developments, this chapter examines how the Indian government now makes more strategic use of its domestic culture of pluralism in its diplomacy and foreign policy strategies towards its neighbouring countries in an effort to offset China's increased influence in the region.

Part III of the volume examines India's evolving relationship with the great powers – the United States, Russia, and Japan. In Chapter 9, **Jayant Prasad** outlines India's relations with the United States and China within the expanded Indo-Pacific strategic theatre and how India manages the twin developments of increased connectivity and increased rivalry in the Indo-Pacific. Prasad presents three interlinked policies India could pursue towards China and the United States to ensure peace and stability in the Indo-Pacific: interdependence through institutions, interdependence through economic cooperation, and balance-of-power politics. In the next chapter, **Harsh V. Pant** examines the evolution in Indo–US relations and argues